

Opening his remarks with pride, Gadkari noted that India's automobile industry has climbed to third place globally, contributing ₹22 lakh crore to the economy, supporting over 4 crore jobs, and generating the highest GST revenue in the country. But he quickly pivoted to that need for road safety reform.

Brake the Habit: Turning awareness into action

One of the headline moments of the evening was Gadkari's launch of Times Drive's "Brake the Habit": a national road safety campaign designed to make responsible driving a cultural norm. The initiative will run long-term, using storytelling, engagement, and on-ground activations to reshape driver behaviour, a large-scale push during Road Safety Week in January.

To make the message stick, the campaign unveiled "Parvaah", a road safety anthem by Shankar Mahadevan, aimed to reach hearts and minds.

"Road safety needs engineering, enforcement, education, and empathy," Gadkari said, emphasising that all four are necessary to bring down accident rates.

Fixing the black spots and building skills

On the engineering front, Gadkari announced ₹40,000 crore in investment to fix accident-prone areas on highways, known as "black spots." Already, 77 high-risk corridors are

"Cars today are no longer just machines; they are both intelligent and responsive," said Chadda. "India is at the heart of this transformation, with mobility solutions that are not only globally competitive but globally relevant."

"The future of mobility is not just about electrification or connectivity," Chadda noted, "It's about trust, safety, and user empowerment, values that Times Drive is now putting front and centre."

— **ROHIT CHADDA**
Times Network President and Co

being redesigned under the Zero Fatality Corridor project.

On the human side, the government plans to open 1,600 new driver training centres to address the shortage of around 22 lakh skilled drivers, a move expected to create over 15 lakh new jobs.

"Automakers across the world are now testing their cars in India," Gadkari said. "That's a testament to the quality of our infrastructure and standards."

Green fuels and energy shift

Road safety wasn't the only topic on the minister's agenda. Gadkari also spoke extensively about reducing India's dependence on imported fossil fuels, which currently costs the nation ₹22 lakh crore annually.

The ministry is promoting ethanol, methanol, biodiesel, CNG, electric, and hydrogen-based alternatives. Trials for

"India is not low-end anymore. It's all about premium experiences. What we are trying to do is bring innovation for India and in India. And we're just getting started."

— **SAVI SOIN**
President, Qualcomm India

"Road safety needs engineering, enforcement, education, and empathy."

— **NITIN GADKARI**
Union Minister of Road Transport & Highways

hydrogen-powered trucks are underway, supported by multiple companies, with nine hydrogen refuelling stations

being set up and a target to produce 5 million metric tonnes of green hydrogen.

The big picture: Collaboration as the engine

What made Snapdragon Auto Day notable wasn't just the announcements; it was the visible alignment between technology providers, policy-makers, and media platforms. Qualcomm has the tech muscle, government is pushing for infrastructure and behavioural change and the media is crafting the narratives to make safety and innovation aspirational.

For Qualcomm, it was clear: they aren't content with being a component supplier. They're positioning themselves as the platform upon which India's automotive future will be built.

Savi Soin summed up the company's stance with a line that could easily serve as the event's headline:

"What we are trying to do is bring innovation for India and in India. And we're just getting started."

The first Snapdragon Auto Day was about planting the seeds of India's next mobility chapter, the coming years will show how deep those roots run and if a vision of safe, smart, connected roads can become a reality. **d**

